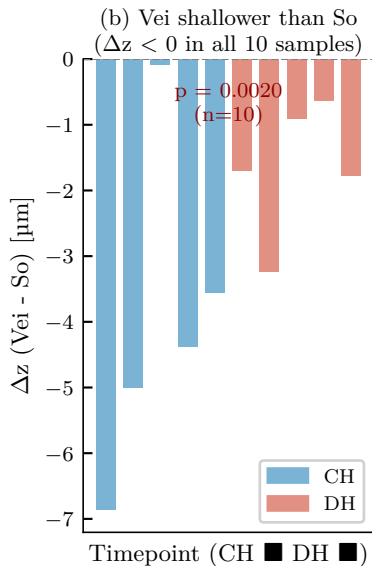
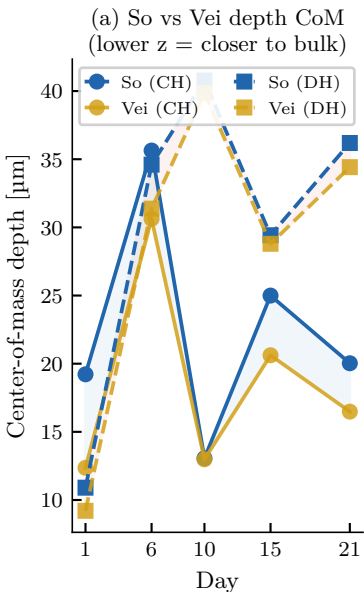


Spatial cross-feeding: *Veillonella* (lactate consumer) is shallower than *S. oralis* (producer)



(c) Comparison with Welch 2016

Welch 2016 (PNAS)

CLASI-FISH, supragingival plaque
Veillonella co-localises with
Streptococcus (metabolic partner);
"interdigitated" spatial arrangement

This study (HOBIC FISH, n = 10)

Vei CoM shallower than *So*
by **2.81 μm** (mean, $p = 0.002$);
consistent in **10/10** timepoints

Interpretation :

Vei sits above *So* (closer to bulk)
→ upward lactate diffusion from
deep *So* to shallow *Vei*
→ AGORA metabolic backbone
confirmed spatially